

Lightning REST/File sources have no DROP path

Zetaris AI Data Gateway — SQL Workspace · Reported by Michael Hay · 2026-09-18

Summary

A data source registered with `CREATE LIGHTNING DATABASE` (used for every REST API and file source — shown in the SQL Workspace's Data Explorer under “File Source & API”) cannot be reliably removed. `DROP TABLE` works for some sources and fails for others with an internal Spark catalog error, and `DROP DATASOURCE` either reports the source doesn't exist, or runs without error while silently leaving the registration in place. No SQL statement, and no UI action we could find, actually deletes the registration. We could not find any documentation (old or current Zetaris SQL manual) describing a working teardown path for this object type.

Evidence

1. DROP TABLE succeeds for one source, fails for another

Two sources were created identically (`CREATE LIGHTNING DATABASE → CREATE LIGHTNING REST TABLE → CREATE SCHEMASTORE VIEW`). Teardown of the first (`POKEAPI_REST`, 2 REST tables) ran with no errors. Teardown of the second (`OFF_LIVE_REST`, 4 REST tables) failed on the very same statement shape:

```
DROP TABLE off_live_rest.nutella_product;
```

```
HiveSQLException: java.util.NoSuchElementException: key not found: off_live_rest
  at org.apache.spark.sql.hive.LightningSessionCatalog.fallbackDropTable(...)
  at org.apache.spark.sql.catalyst.catalog.InMemoryCatalog.dropTable(...)
```

The trace shows the call falling back to Spark's own native session catalog, which has no entry for `off_live_rest` as a database — even though `SELECT` and `DROP VIEW` against the same name worked correctly in the same session, moments earlier.

2. DROP DATASOURCE reports the source doesn't exist

```
DROP DATASOURCE OFF_LIVE_REST;
```

```
Data Source : 'OFF_LIVE_REST' doesn't exist
```

This is the exact name and case used at creation (`CREATE LIGHTNING DATABASE OFF_LIVE_REST`), and the source is visibly present in the Data Explorer at the time this statement is run.

3. A prior “successful” DROP DATASOURCE did not actually remove anything

`DROP DATASOURCE POKEAPI_REST;` was run earlier in the same session and reported no error. Re-checking the Data Explorer afterward, `POKEAPI_REST` is still listed under “File Source & API”. The statement most likely silently no-op'd rather than performing a real drop.

4. DROP VIEW is the only operation that behaves consistently

`DROP VIEW <container>.<view>` against `SCHEMASTORE` views worked correctly in both cases above, with no inconsistency observed.

Documentation reviewed

Both the legacy Lightning SQL Manual (data-fabric.readthedocs.io) and the current kbase.zetaris.com SQL manual were checked end to end, along with the File System Overview, Data Catalog Overview, and the “Processes for Automation: Table, View, Schema creation / deletion” knowledge-base articles. Findings:

- `DROP DATASOURCE` is documented with a JDBC-style example (`DROP DATASOURCE ORCL`, matching a `CREATE DATASOURCE ... OPTIONS (jdbcdriver ...)` registration) — it does not appear to be written with `CREATE LIGHTNING DATABASE` sources in mind at all.

- No DROP LIGHTNING DATABASE (or equivalent) statement is documented anywhere in either manual.
- The only documented UI-based delete instructions we found are for removing a view via the Query Builder's bin icon — nothing for a File Source & API entry.

Impact

- No confirmed way to remove a REST or file source once it is created — test/demo registrations accumulate in the Data Explorer with no cleanup path.
- Blocks a repeatable create → test → tear down workflow in the SQL Workspace, which is the normal cycle for iterating on a new source.
- The inconsistent DROP TABLE behavior (works for one source, fails for a near-identical one) makes teardown unpredictable even at the table level, independent of the datasource-level gap.

Request

- Confirm whether a working DROP path exists for a CREATE LIGHTNING DATABASE-registered source (SQL statement or UI action) that isn't currently documented.
- If none exists, treat this as a product gap: either add a DROP LIGHTNING DATABASE / DROP DATASOURCE code path that recognizes Lightning-registered sources, or add a delete action to the Data Explorer's File Source & API panel.
- Investigate the DROP TABLE inconsistency (works on a 2-table source, fails on a 4-table source with an identical statement shape) as a separate but related defect.

Environment: Zetaris AI Data Gateway (cloud.zetaris.com), SQL Workspace. Sources created via CREATE LIGHTNING DATABASE + CREATE LIGHTNING REST TABLE + CREATE SCHEMASTORE VIEW against two public REST APIs (PokéAPI, Open Food Facts) for onboarding evaluation purposes.